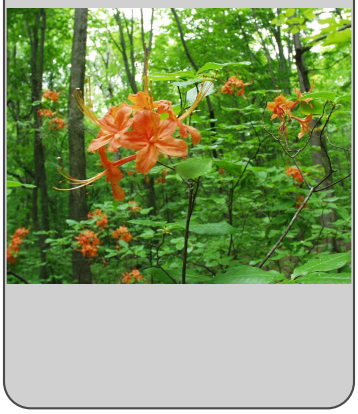
Atlanta Botanical Garden - Expansion

Rhododendron flammeum 'Orange Carpet'

Orange Carpet Oconee Azalea

Also known as: Rhododendron speciosum | Family: Ericaceae

Beltline N_S: 16 | Passage N_S: 33 | **TOTAL 49**



HABIT



OTHER



OTHER



FLOWER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Not stated

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: Typically 6–8 ft (1.8–2.5 m) high × 6–8 ft (1.8–2.5 m) wide for the species. Upright to rounded / mounding habit. 'Orange Carpet' is a selection; specific size not detailed in available

Sun

Water

Soil
Moist but well-drained, acidic, humus-rich, organically rich soil. Prefers shelter from strong winds and frost pockets

Zone 8a
Hardy in USDA Zones 6–9. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a. Native to hot areas of the Southeast (Georgia, etc.). Exceptionally heat- and drought-tolerant for the genus. Mid-April blooms in hot colors (orange, red, yellow).
Attracts hummingbirds and butterflies

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Selection of Rhododendron flammeum (Oconee / Piedmont azalea), native to the southeastern United States (primarily Georgia and adjacent states). Species is known for heat tolerance and variable hot-colored flowers.
'Orange Carpet' is a named selection emphasizing orange tones

Form
Deciduous azalea with upright to rounded habit. Alternate thin oval leaves (to ~3.5 in) that turn yellow in fall. Large clusters of widely funnel-shaped flowers in shades of orange, red, yellow (often mixed) with blotch, appearing as leaves emerge in mid to late spring. Non-fragrant. Shallow fibrous roots. Native southeastern deciduous azalea prized for heat tolerance and vibrant spring flowers in orange-red-yellow range. 'Orange Carpet' selection. Fragrant in some related natives; this species non-fragrant.
Good fall color (yellow). Shallow roots

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant in partial shade with moist, acidic, well-drained, organic soil. Mulch annually. Minimal pruning after flowering. Excellent for shady borders. Attracts pollinators. Drought tolerant once established. Native deciduous azalea

HEALTH

Health

Generally trouble-free if planted correctly in acidic, well-drained conditions. May be susceptible to typical azalea issues (vine weevil, lacebug, powdery mildew, Phytophthora) if stressed. Heat and drought tolerant once established

Symptoms

None stated